



Wooden fruit

Not all fruit is edible: the fruit of pine trees are wooden cones. Pine trees take two years to make seeds, which are kept safe inside the cones. When the seeds are ready, the cones burst open. The seeds fall to the ground, where many will be eaten by forest animals and birds.

Seeds



Spores on underside of a fern leaf.



Scores of spores

Non-flowering plants do not have seeds. Ferns have spores instead, which can be seen on the underside of the leaves. When the spores are ripe, they fall off the leaf.

New potato plants sprouting.

Sprouting spuds

Have you ever seen an old, wrinkly potato? It probably has “eyes” – green buds that will grow into new plants. Potatoes are not seeds, but tubers, which are underground food stores for the plant.

Strawberries have seeds, but new plants grow more easily from runners.

